

August 31, 2026

Quora

Dear Hiring Team,

I am writing to apply for the Data Scientist - Quora position. I recently completed my M.Sc. in Computer Science at the University of Calgary, and I am interested in this role because it sits at the intersection of rigorous analysis, product judgment, experimentation, and knowledge-sharing at scale.

My graduate research focused on building machine-learning and data-management systems for large geospatial and Earth observation datasets. I developed Python and C++ pipelines for data collection, preprocessing, validation, storage, retrieval, model training, and performance evaluation. The work required careful attention to data quality, sampling strategy, scalability, and computational efficiency, because small choices in data preparation could change the conclusions drawn from a model.

One of my main projects examined the reliability and generalizability of deep-learning models for digital elevation model super-resolution. I built workflows using Python, NumPy, pandas, Rasterio, and PyTorch; trained convolutional neural networks; and evaluated performance using RMSE, slope, TRI, TPI, and wavelet-based metrics. Through experimentation, I found that random data splits could produce overly optimistic results, then used region-based validation to make the evaluation more honest and useful.

My second major research area involved a DGGS-based framework for managing and retrieving large volumes of spatiotemporal satellite data. I designed multiresolution storage and retrieval methods, implemented performance-sensitive C++ components, and evaluated the system using large Canada-wide datasets. This strengthened my ability to work with messy, high-volume data and communicate the tradeoffs behind technical decisions through a thesis and first-author publication.

I also bring backend and database experience from Asr Gooyesh Pardaz, where I developed Django REST APIs backed by PostgreSQL for NLP, text-to-speech, and speech-to-text products. I implemented authentication features, payment-service integration, and relational records for plan and payment workflows. This experience helps me connect analysis and modelling with production code, databases, and user-facing product behaviour.

Quora's emphasis on empiricism, experimentation, and practical product impact is a strong fit for how I like to work. I enjoy turning broad questions into measurable hypotheses, building careful analyses, checking whether results are robust, and explaining findings clearly. As a teaching assistant in big data, data-at-scale, and database courses, I also developed the communication skills needed to make technical conclusions understandable to different audiences.

My background is strongest in Python, PyTorch, pandas, NumPy, SQL, PostgreSQL, Git, Linux, model evaluation, and large-scale data workflows. I would bring strong analytical discipline, research independence, software engineering judgment, and a genuine interest in products that help people learn from one another.

Thank you for considering my application. I would welcome the opportunity to discuss how my data-science, ML evaluation, scalable-data, and technical communication background could contribute to Quora's Data Team.

Sincerely,
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